

for his family, are brought out with fine craftsmanship.

Apparently, Shah Rukh would have highly charged exchanges with Kundan Shah on the sets of *Kabhi Haan Kabhi Na*, a film that laid the way to his meteoric rise. Yet, when Shah ran out of money to buy raw film stock and okayed a shot Shah Rukh knew he actually wanted re-taken, he scoured all adjoining sets to borrow some at 3 a.m., returning to Shah's sets and crying like a child. Then there was the time he went straight to directors Abbas-Mustan's home in Mumbai to touch their feet immediately after winning his first best actor trophy.



The book helps every lover of Shah Rukh's passionate screen depictions to understand what lies behind his throbbingly infectious energy and that touch of impulsiveness. That's why he was so realistic in *Baazigar* and *Darr*, playing roles most actors would not touch.

Clearly, Chopra has targeted an international audience. The introduction may read somewhat simplistic to avid followers of Hindi cinema in India. But the author has written an eminently readable book, which I believe would be read and loved by everybody. ■

TOP 10

BESTSELLERS

A monthly national list of bestselling books compiled for INDIA TODAY by ORG-MARG based on data from 15 retail outlets in six cities.

FICTION

NO.	TITLE	AUTHOR	PUBLISHER
1. (12)	A Thousand Splendid Suns	Khaled Hosseini	Bloomsbury
2. (9)	The Kite Runner	Khaled Hosseini	Bloomsbury/Penguin
3. (1)	The Witch of Portobello	Paulo Coelho	HarperCollins
4. (16)	The Collectors	David Baldacci	Macmillan
5. (-)	The Curious Incident of the Dog in the Night-Time	Mark Haddon	Vintage

NON-FICTION

NO.	TITLE	AUTHOR	PUBLISHER
1. (3)	The Secret	Rhonda Byrne	Atria
2. (-)	In Spite of the Gods: The Strange Rise of Modern India	Edward Luce	Random House
3. (1)	It Happened in India	Kishore Biyani, Dipayan Baishya	Rupa
4. (-)	India's Unending Journey	Mark Tully	Rider
5. (11)	The Last Mughal	William Dalrymple	Penguin

OTHER INDIAN BOOKS IN THE TOP 20

FICTION

NO.	TITLE	AUTHOR	PUBLISHER
11. (-)	Passion India	Javier Moro	Full Circle
14. (4)	The Inheritance of Loss	Kiran Desai	Penguin
15. (8)	Shantaram	Gregory David Roberts	Penguin
20. (-)	Chowringhee	Sankar	Penguin

NON-FICTION

NO.	TITLE	AUTHOR	PUBLISHER
6. (-)	The Last Nizam: An Indian Prince in the Australian Outback	John Zubrzycki	HarperCollins
8. (-)	The Indians: Portrait of a People	Sudhir Kakar and Katharina Kakar	Penguin
9. (7)	India After Gandhi: The History of the World's Largest Democracy	Ramachandra Guha	Picador
10. (6)	The Monk Who Sold His Ferrari	Robin S. Sharma	Jaico

Last month's rating in brackets

Participating bookshops: Delhi: Om Book Shop, Faqir Chand, Teksons, Full Circle; Mumbai: Crossword, Shah Book Stall, Danai Book Shop; Bangalore: Fountainhead, Gangarams; Hyderabad: Walden Book Link, The Book Point; Kolkata: Oxford Books, Modern Book Depot, Family Book Shop; Chennai: Fountainhead